

Here comes a new sound card for Raspberry Pi!

Element 14, the distributor of Raspberry Pi, has launched a little sound card, the Wolfson Audio Card, created in collaboration with Wolfson Audio, for its hugely popular single-board computer. The \$33 Wolfson Audio Card sits on Pi's P5 pins and promises PC-like audio capture capabilities. It has all the features typically found on a sound card.

Earlier, the Raspberry Pi had an audio output through its HDMI port. However, the new Wolfson Audio Card extends and improves the board's qualities. This new card supports high-res audio up to 24-bit/192 kHz. The card outputs audio through a 3.5 mm line out. It also supports analogue and digital audio inputs along with 2W class-D speaker outputs.

"With its comprehensive feature set, ease of use and extremely good audio quality, designers will have a completely new audio tool set to work from," said David Shen, CTO, Element14. The company expects that the new audio card will be helpful to create video capture devices, networked audio receivers, and voice-over-IP applications.

A new wristband uses the pulse as the password

In keeping with the latest trend in wearable devices, here comes a new hi-tech wristband, which records the wearer's pulse as a password. The band is a security device that authenticates you based on its reading of your pulse.

A start-up company, Bionym, has developed the Nyimi wristband. It uses dual electrodes, which are integrated into its clasp to sense the wearers' pulse when they touch the clasp even for a few seconds. The device has an accelerometer and a gyroscope, and fitness apps are in development too.

The sensors of Nyimi can also be used for gesture recognition, so one can possibly incorporate movement and triggers into the authentication process, other than just the pulse reading of the original wearer.

Despite introducing the feature a year back in the US, Facebook did not launch it in most countries, with India being one of the new countries to get the service in the last few months.

Dropbox seeks to partner with Indian firms

San Francisco-based Dropbox Inc, the cloud storage firm, is reportedly looking to collaborate with Indian mobile service providers and Web companies. According to reports, while the firm doesn't have any plans to set up offices in the country yet, it wants to reach the huge smartphone and Internet user base that India has.

According to the report, Dropbox is currently holding talks with many Indian companies and large corporations. Dropbox VP, Business Development, Sujay Jaswa said that the talks are currently at the very early stages.

The company is valued at around US\$ 10 billion and has often been touted as the next Facebook or Twitter to come out from the Silicon Valley. India was recently found to be the fastest growing smartphone market in the world by research firm Gartner. This is the reason behind such companies taking an interest in the Indian market.



Dropbox

Fedora 21 to come out with crucial security, crypto upgrades

The Fedora Engineering and Steering Committee has approved a slew of new features in the latest iteration of Red Hat's Fedora distro—Fedora 21. As the deadline for specifying the final changes in Fedora 21 draws nearer (April 8), it is now clear that the release will come with crucial security and crypto upgrades.

Thanks to a new system-wide policy, all applications running on a given Fedora system can have a consistent level of cryptography set between them. This will unify the crypto policies used by different applications and libraries in Fedora 21. In terms of security, Fedora 21 would have a set of predefined levels that will individually define various cryptography related behaviours. The changes in crypto and security levels would eventually require changes in the likes of GnuTLS, recently marred by a long-undetected bug that could have allowed potential data theft via a specially crafted encryption certificate. Keeping all this in mind, the final set of changes in Fedora 21 is still under wraps.



IBM brings Big Data to Bollywood

If you thought Big Data analytics was reserved for IT firms, think again. Technology giant IBM is bringing data crunching and analytics to Bollywood. According to a report by the Times of India (TOI), the company believes that Big Data analytics can help directors and producers make films that have a better chance of doing well, rather than merely relying on their instincts.

The report further states that IBM used its data analytics technologies on the